

Purpose: To remind us of our responsibility to be witnesses of Jesus Christ and to help us see how the gift of the Holy Ghost helps us do so.

†1. Why study Acts?

1. The Lord ascends into heaven. Matthias is called to be an Apostle.

- Read and discuss [Acts 1](#).
 - Acts 1:1-3. “To whom also he shewed himself alive ... being seen of them forty days,” and teaching them.
 - Acts 1:4-5. Christ “commanded them ... [to] wait for ... the Holy Ghost not many days hence.”
 - Acts 1:8. Ye “shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me”.
- What is the role of the Holy Ghost in our efforts to teach the Gospel? (See [2 Nephi 33:1](#); [D&C 42:14](#).)

†2. President Boyd K. Packer

- Acts 1:9-11. Two men in white said: “this same Jesus ... shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go”.
- Acts 1:12-14; 21-26. “Then returned they unto Jerusalem from the mount ... [and] they went up into an upper room”.

2. On the day of Pentecost, the Apostles are filled with the Holy Ghost.

- Read and discuss [Acts 2](#). †3. Manifestation of the Holy Ghost at the Kirtland Temple †4. Wilford Woodruff
- The “feast of Pentecost was a harvest celebration held 50 days after the Feast of the Passover. Jews from many nations came to Jerusalem for this feast.” (See Bible Dictionary, “[Feasts](#),” 673.) (*Lesson Manual*)
- Acts 2:1-4. “And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, there were all with one accord in one place.”
- This fulfilled our Savior’s promises recorded here: [John 14:26](#), [15:26](#), and [16:7-14](#) and in [Acts 1:5](#).
- Acts 2:5-13. “And there were dwelling at Jerusalem Jews, devout men, out of every nation under heaven.”
 - [D&C 90:11](#); [100:5-8](#). In “that day ... every man shall hear the fulness of the gospel in his own tongue”.
 - Acts 2:14-24, 36. “But Peter ... said ... Ye men of Judaea ... these are not drunken, as ye suppose”.
 - Acts 2:37-38. “Now when they heard this, they were pricked in their heart, and said ... what shall we do?”
 - Acts 2:41-47. And “the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.”
- What can we learn from their example?

3. Peter and John heal a lame man by the power of Jesus Christ.

- Read and discuss [Acts 3-4](#).
 - Acts 3:1-11. “such as I have give I thee: ... In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk”.
- How have you felt the healing power of Jesus Christ in your life?
- Acts 3:12-26; [4:5-12](#). Peter used this miracle as an opportunity to testify of Jesus Christ.
- What opportunities do we have to testify of Christ?
- Acts 4:1-4. Jewish leaders were “grieved that they ... preached through Jesus the resurrection,” but 5000 believed.
- What does our response to the words of Church leaders reveal about the condition of our hearts?
- Acts 4:13-18. “And they ... commanded them not to speak at all nor teach in the name of Jesus.”
 - Acts 4:19-20. “But Peter and John answered ... we cannot but speak the things which we have seen and heard.”
- What are some circumstances in your life that might require courage in being a witness for Jesus Christ?
- Acts 4:23-30. “And now, Lord ... grant unto thy servants, that with all boldness they may speak thy word”.
 - Acts 4:31-35. “they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, ... [and preached boldly] but they had all things in common.”

4. The Apostles continue to preach and heal with great power.

- Read and discuss [Acts 5:12-42](#).
 - Acts 5:12-20. “And by the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people”.
 - Acts 5:21-32. “And we are witnesses of these things; and so also is the Holy Ghost”.
 - Acts 5:33-42. “Then stood ... a Pharisee, named Gamaliel, a doctor of the law, had in reputation among all”.
- What change did the gift of the Holy Ghost bring about in the Apostles?
- (Compare [Matthew 26:47-56, 69-75](#) with [Acts 4:5-21](#); [5:17-18, 26-42](#).)

How can the Apostles’ examples inspire us to be witnesses of the truth?

†5. Sharing the Gospel with Friends: A Group Approach †6. The Missionary Work We Call Home Teaching

Next Week: L29 “The Number of the Disciples Was Multiplied”; See L29: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

Read the Institute New Testament Student Manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NTL28 Quotes

†1. **Why study Acts?:** “The Acts of the Apostles forms an important bridge between the life and teachings of Jesus Christ and the writings and labors of His Apostles. The book of Acts provides us with our principal view of the Church of Jesus Christ during its formative years. In it we see the members and leaders of the infant Church working to overcome the problems encountered when the teachings of Jesus Christ came in conflict with Jewish traditions and Gentile influences. Unlike the four Gospels, which share a large amount of similar content, the book of Acts stands relatively alone; without it, the only information we would have about the early history of the Church would be the small amount provided by the New Testament epistles. In addition, Acts provides valuable historical context for the epistles of Paul.” (*New Testament Student Manual*, [Chapter 29: Acts 1-2](#), Why study Acts?)

†2. **President Boyd K. Packer:** “Anciently the Lord called and ordained Twelve Apostles. He was betrayed and crucified. After His Resurrection, the Savior taught His disciples for 40 days and then ascended into heaven.

“**But something was missing.** A few days later the Twelve gathered in a house, and ‘suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house... Cloven tongues ... of fire [rested] upon each of them. And they were ... filled with the Holy Ghost.’ His Apostles were now empowered. They understood that the authority given by the Savior and the gift of the Holy Ghost were essential for the establishment of His Church. They were commanded to baptize and confer the gift of the Holy Ghost.” (“[Guided by the Holy Spirit](#),” *Ensign*, May 2011, 30)

†3. **Manifestation of the Holy Ghost at the Kirtland Temple:** The Prophet Joseph Smith said that at an evening meeting on the day the Kirtland Temple was dedicated, “Brother George A. Smith arose and began to prophesy, when a noise was heard **like the sound of a rushing mighty wind**, which filled the Temple, and all the congregation simultaneously arose, being moved upon by an invisible power; many began to speak in tongues and prophesy; others saw glorious visions; and I beheld the Temple was filled with angels, which fact I declared to the congregation. The people of the neighborhood came running together (hearing an unusual sound within, and seeing a bright light like a pillar of fire resting upon the Temple), and were astonished at what was taking place? (*History of the Church*, 2:428).

†4. **Wilford Woodruff:** “You may have the administration of angels, you may see many miracles; you may see many wonders in the earth; but I claim that

the gift of the Holy Ghost is the greatest gift that can be bestowed upon man...

“You may surround any man or woman with all the wealth and glory that the imagination of man can grasp, and are they satisfied? No. There is still an aching void. **On the other hand, show me a beggar upon the streets, who has the Holy Ghost, whose mind is filled with that spirit and power, and I will show you a person who has peace of mind, who possesses true riches, and those enjoyments that no man can obtain from any other source.**” (*Discourses of Wilford Woodruff*, ed. G. Homer Durham, 5.)

†5. “[Sharing the Gospel with Friends: A Group Approach](#),” Robert L. Hamlin, *Ensign*, April 1982, 37.

“When we first used this approach, we were very surprised. **About two thirds of our friends accepted.** After merely asking just sixteen couples on the original list, we had two groups of six investigators each...

“**As we hoped, the Spirit of those meetings was very strong. Overwhelmed by the experience, most of the nonmembers were visibly moved...**

“When all of the lessons were completed, we thanked everyone for participating and told them we would be calling at their homes. Within two or three days, with the elders we visited each couple, answered any remaining questions, and then simply invited them to join the Church. **To our surprise, in the first group about two thirds of the investigators accepted the invitation.**”

†6. “[The Missionary Work We Call Home Teaching](#),” Jay A. Parry, *Ensign*, October 1982, 7.

“As Harold B. Lee said in 1964, ‘**Missionary work is but home teaching to those who are not now members of the Church, and home teaching is nothing more or less than the missionary work to Church members.**’” (*Improvement Era*, Dec. 1964, p. 1078)

Recommended Reading:

1. [NT28 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and talks.
2. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 29: Acts 1-2](#).
3. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, [Chapter 30: Acts 3-7](#).
4. President Boyd K. Packer, “[Guided by the Holy Spirit](#),” *Ensign*, May 2011, 30).
5. Sandra Marsaw, “[Called to Rescue](#),” *Ensign*, April 2015.

Visit stephenmbird.com